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The controversies

Over the years, a lot has been written about the various controversial situations I have found myself in. Once and for all, let me set the record straight.

As explosive as my batting can be, it hasn't quite matched the pyrotechnics of my life off the field. Unfortunately some of my escapades have filled as many newspaper column inches as my cricketing performances. As you now know, I've managed to land myself in the kak with alarming regularity right from the start of my cricket career. A stint in rehab for alcohol abuse and a messy divorce would be more than enough controversy for most professional athletes, but with me, that wasn't the half of it. Here's a run-through of my own personal highlights. And why not start with the biggie?

The match-fixing scandal

It was 6.30 a.m., and knocking on my door was the Proteas team captain, Hansie Cronjé. We were touring India in 2000, and in Nagpur about to play our final ODI match against India. My roommate, fast bowler Henry Williams, was in the shower when Hansie sat down on the bed. He got straight to the point. 'I've got a mate here in India,' he said, 'and you can make some good money if you do what he's asking. He's offering US$15 000 if you go out for less than 20 in today's game.'

I'd like to tell you that this was one of those moments when someone says something so unexpected to you that you first frown like you can't quite believe what you're hearing and then your jaw drops as the words sink in. But that wouldn't be entirely true.

This had happened before.